

JUNIOR SCHOOL EDUCATION

SOCIAL STUDIES

G9

2025



SOCIAL STUDIES AND CAREER DEVELOPMENT

PATHWAY CHOICES

A **career** is the professional journey that one chooses to follow to pursue one's interest and achieve one's goal in work life

Career paths

1. Health care
 - Doctor
 - Pharmacist
 - Nurse
 - Medical researcher
2. Business and finance
 - Entrepreneur
 - Marketing manager
 - Accountant
 - Business consultant
3. Education
 - Teacher
 - School principal
 - Special education teacher
 - Education administrator
4. Law and legal services
 - LAWYER
 - Judge
 - Legal consultant
 - Legal secretary
5. Environmental and sustainability
6. Communication and media
 - Journalist
 - Content writer
 - Social media manager
 - News anchor
7. Hospitality and tourism
 - Travel agent
 - Tour guide

Identifying factors to consider in the selection of a pathway

The following are factors to consider in the selection of a career pathway:

a) Personal interests –

Choose a career that aligns with your passion and interests. Consider the activities or subjects you enjoy the most and explore career options related to those areas.

b) Skills and abilities

Assess your strengths and abilities. Identify the skills you excel in and consider careers that allow you to utilise and further develop those skills.

c) Values and motivations

Reflect on your values and what motivates you. Consider the type of work environment, culture and values that are important to you and find a career that aligns with those principles.

d) Education and training

Evaluate the educational and training requirements for different career paths. Determine if you are willing and able to pursue the necessary education or training to enter your desired field.

e) Networking opportunities

Research the networking opportunities available in different fields. Consider the importance of professional connections and how they can contribute to career growth.

f) Personal fulfillment

Aim for a career that provides a sense of purpose and allows you to make a positive impact in the areas that matter to you.

Requirements for social sciences pathway at senior school

To pursue a career in the field of Social Sciences in senior school requires the following requirements:

a) Learning areas or educational subjects

relevant courses in Social Studies, History, Psychology, Sociology, Economics, and Geography. These subjects provide a solid foundation for understanding human behaviour, societies and the broader Social Sciences.

b) Research and critical thinking –

develop research skills and critical thinking abilities by engaging in class projects, independent research or participating in academic competitions. These experiences can enhance your problem-solving skills, which are valuable in Social Science careers.

c) Writing and communication skills

Work on improving your writing and communication skills, as Social Science careers often involve presenting ideas, conducting research and writing reports or essays.

d) Extracurricular activities –

Participate in extracurricular activities related to Social Sciences, such as joining a Social Science club, volunteering for community organisations or attending lectures and workshops. These activities can demonstrate your passion for the field and provide practical experiences. **e) Networking –**

Build connections with teachers, mentors and professionals in the Social Sciences. Attend career fairs or workshops to meet individuals working in the field and learn from their experiences.

Appreciating the need for choosing a pathway in senior school

The following is the need for choosing a pathway in senior school.

- a) It helps you to focus on subjects and activities that genuinely interest you. It gives you a clear direction for your academic journey.
- b) By selecting a pathway, you get a chance to discover your passions and talents.
- c) It allows you to set goals and work towards achieving them. It gives you a sense of purpose and motivation to strive for success in your chosen field.
- d) It offers specialised knowledge and skills related to a specific area. It helps you gain a deeper understanding of subjects you enjoy and prepares you for future studies.
- e) It encourages personal growth and development. It allows you to challenge yourself, learn new things and become more confident in your abilities.
- f) It helps you to align your studies with your future career. By focusing on subjects relevant to your chosen field, you build a strong foundation and gain valuable skills for future success.
- g) It provides you with guidance and support from teachers and mentors who specialise in that area. They can offer valuable guidance and help you in your academic journey.

Pre career support systems

Exploring the importance of different support systems for holistic development in a school community

Meaning of support systems in a school community

- A support system is a group of people and resources in school that help learners succeed in any challenges they may face while in school
- They provide encouragement, guidance and resources to help learners reach their goals and overcome challenges

The following are examples of support systems in a school community:

- a) School administration - the head teacher, deputy principals, teachers and other school staff work closely to help ensure a safe, productive learning environment for students. They work with the community to address any issues or concerns that arise in the school community.
- b) Guidance and Counseling - school counsellors provide academic, social-emotional and career guidance to learners. The school counsellors meet with learners individually or in small groups to help them develop important life skills, cope with personal challenges, and plan for their future.
- c) School nurse's office - this is an important resource for learners who become sick or get injured while in school. The nurse can provide first aid, administer medications and connect learners and families with additional medical resources if needed.
- d) Parent-teacher meetings - these are regular meetings between parents and teachers that allow for open communication about a learner's progress, strengths, and areas for improvement.

These meetings help to ensure that everyone is working together to support the learner's academic and personal growth.

The significance of pre career mapping for individual growth

- A pre career is the process of discovering yourself and possible career paths before you decide on specific future career

Significance	Explanation
Reducing regrets	
Adaptability	
Continuous learning	
Practice approach	
Informed decisions	
Clarity and direction	
Goal setting	
Skill development	

The following are importance of pre-career mapping to individual growth.

- ✓ Helps discover interests by helping individuals to explore their interests and passions, allowing them to choose a career path that they truly enjoy.
- ✓ Set clear and specific goals for their future careers, giving them a sense of direction and purpose.
- ✓ Guides decision-making where individuals can make informed decisions about education, training, and skill development, ensuring they are on the right track to reach their desired career.
- ✓ Increases motivation by making one more determined to work towards their career goals.
- ✓ Promotes self awareness by encouraging self reflection, helping individuals understand their strengths, weakness and values, leading to better career choices

Using support systems for pre career development in the school community

A career support system helps learners in development of careers in schools through the following ways

- Provide guidance on career options and helps to explore different paths based on their skills and interest and prepares them for job applications and college admissions
- Alumni connect learners with graduates who can share their career experiences, offer mentorship and provide insights into specific industries or universities.
- Connects learners with experienced professionals who offer career advice and provide emotional support.

- Mentors can be role models, they help learners develop professional skills and offer networking opportunities.
- Provides a safe space for learners to discuss personal challenges, explore values and meaning-making and offer spiritual guidance.
- Chaplains can help learners overcome personal anxieties related to career choices, fostering a sense of well-being that impacts career focus.
- Provides support for learners facing socio-economic challenges for example, food insecurity and housing instability that can impact their ability to focus on career development.
- Provides resources for learners to manage stress, improve mental and physical health and develop healthy habits that contribute to overall well-being.
- Provides health resources for learners to manage stress, improve mental and physical health and develop healthy habits that contribute to overall well-being.

Designing solutions to challenges arising from use of support systems **Challenges arising from use of support systems**

Pre-career support systems are there to help, but they can also present some challenges.

The following are examples of challenges from pre-career support systems.

- a) Limited resources - schools may have limited funding or staffing for pre-career support systems, which can result in a lack of career counsellors or limited access to career exploration materials and tools.
- b) High learner-to-counsellor ratio - schools may have a high number of students per career counsellor making it challenging for counsellors to provide individualised guidance and support to each student.
- c) Lack of parental involvement - parents play an important role in supporting their children's career development. However, pre-career support systems may struggle to engage parents effectively, leading to limited parental involvement in career planning discussions and activities.
- d) Limited scope - programs might focus on specific industries or job types, which might not be ideal if you are undecided or have a unique career path.
- e) Passive participation getting - the most out of support systems often requires your initiative. If you are shy or unsure what to ask for, it can be hard to benefit fully.

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